



Imagine an insect that looks like a cross between a cricket and a mole, with front legs that look like miniature bulldozers. That's our friend, the mole cricket, a creature as interesting as it is unique. They aren't very big, usually around 1 to 2 inches in length, and are usually brownish in color. A couple of their unique features are their sturdy front legs designed for digging, and their long antennae that help them sense their surroundings.



Speaking of surroundings, mole crickets don't live just anywhere. They prefer inhabiting warm, moist places, and you can often find them underground in fields, gardens, or near water bodies. Their super strong front legs, remember the mini bulldozers, help them dig intricate tunnels in the soil. And guess what? This is where they spend most of their lives, cozy and hidden away.

Now, you might be wondering, 'What does our friend eat while living underground?' Well, these little diggers are omnivores, which means they eat both plants and other small creatures. Their diet includes roots, grasses, insects, and even their own kind if food is scarce! When it comes to their life cycle, they start as eggs, become nymphs (think of it as the teenage stage for insects), and then grow into adults, all within a year's time.



Our final stop on this journey is to understand how these critters interact with us and the world around them. While they might seem scary to some, mole crickets aren't harmful to humans at all. However, they can sometimes be a nuisance to farmers and gardeners because they love munching on plant roots. To protect themselves from predators, mole crickets can both fly and burrow quickly into the ground - a dual escape plan, how cool is that!



Solve each problem.

Use the article to answer the question.

- 1) What color are mole crickets?
A. red B. green C. brown D. yellow
- 2) What defense will mole crickets do to protect themselves from predators?
A. play dead B. camouflage themselves
C. fly away D. spit venom
- 3) What are mole cricket's unique features?
A. horns and sharp fangs B. sturdy front legs designed for digging
C. wings and sharp claws D. bright colors
- 4) Are mole crickets harmful to humans?
A. yes, at all ages B. yes, when they are adults
C. yes, when they are nymphs D. no, not usually
- 5) How long does it take for mole crickets to become adults?
A. one year B. one month C. one week D. one day
- 6) What do mole crickets use their front legs for?
A. digging B. swimming C. fighting D. jumping
- 7) Where do mole crickets prefer to live?
A. dry, barren places B. cold, dry places
C. hot, humid places D. warm, moist places
- 8) What do mole crickets use their front legs for?
A. Catching insects B. Digging tunnels
C. Creating holes in trees D. Climbing trees
- 9) About how large are mole crickets?
A. Microscopic B. Around 2 inches
C. About 1 foot D. Larger than 6 inches
- 10) What do mole crickets eat?
A. only insects and spiders B. plants and other small creatures
C. only other mole crickets D. only plants

Determine if the statements is something the animal would say (W) or it it is not something the animal would say (N).

- 11) "I enjoy the dry and cold places."
- 12) "We mole crickets hate to stay hidden."
- 13) "My front legs are just right for digging through the soil. They are my personal bulldozers!"
- 14) "We mole crickets are really big, around 4 to 5 inches in length."
- 15) "I never eat other insects, that's gross."
- 16) "We live in the harsh cold of the mountains."
- 17) "I often hide myself in the soil, in fields and gardens. It's cozy and safe."
- 18) "My life cycle is quite rapid. I start as an egg and become an adult in just a year."



- 19) "Size isn't everything. I'm only about an inch or two long, but I'm mighty in my own way!"
- 20) "I live for many years, almost as long as a human."
- 21) "I absolutely dislike staying near water bodies."
- 22) "Farmers and gardeners love us, we help their plants grow."
- 23) "I'm a bit picky about where I settle. I like places that are warm and moist. They make the best homes!"
- 24) "I prefer eating fruits and vegetables."
- 25) "Although I won't harm you, I can be a nuisance to farmers and gardeners. Beware of my munching habit!"
- 26) "Sometimes, if food is scarce, I might have to eat other mole crickets. It's not something I prefer."
- 27) "When I'm not digging, I'm eating. I enjoy a good mix of roots, grasses, and even bugs."
- 28) "We are dangerous and harmful to humans."
- 29) "You won't believe it, but I can actually fly. A flying bulldozer, that's quite a sight."
- 30) "No need to be scared of me. I won't hurt you. I just like digging in the soil."

Determine if the statement is a fact or opinion based on the information in the article.

- 31) The life cycle of a mole cricket goes from egg to nymph to adult all within a year.
- 32) It's gross that mole crickets eat other mole crickets.
- 33) Mole crickets eat plants, insects and sometimes even their own kind.
- 34) It is amazing that mole crickets can live underground most of their lives.
- 35) Mole crickets usually live in warm, moist places like gardens, fields or near water bodies.
- 36) It's amazing that mole crickets can both fly and dig underground to protect themselves.
- 37) Mole crickets can be a problem for farmers and gardeners because they eat plant roots.
- 38) Most of the time, mole crickets live underground in tunnels that they dig themselves.
- 39) Mole crickets ability to dig intricate tunnels is incredible.
- 40) Mole crickets are fascinating because their front legs look like mini bulldozers.

Determine if the statement is true or false.

- 41) Mole crickets can escape danger by flying.
- 42) Mole crickets are harmful to humans.
- 43) Mole crickets will eat plant roots.
- 44) Mole crickets are usually blue or purple in color.
- 45) Mole crickets can be a nuisance to gardeners because of their diet.
- 46) Mole crickets can grow to over 5 inches in length.
- 47) Mole crickets only eat other insects.
- 48) Mole crickets prefer to live in dry areas.
- 49) Mole crickets use their antennae to sense their surroundings.
- 50) Mole crickets use their front legs for digging.

Determine which choice is the expanded form of the underlined contraction.



- 51) Mole crickets don't eat just plants; they eat insects too!
A. does not B. are not
C. cannot D. do not
- 52) Mole crickets can't see very well in the dark.
A. can B. could not
C. can not D. cannot
- 53) Mole crickets don't get very large.
A. does not B. do
C. are not D. do not
- 54) Mole crickets can't fly when they're young.
A. will not B. are not
C. do not D. cannot
- 55) They're helpful by eating harmful bugs.
A. They have B. They were
C. They are D. They do
- 56) Their front legs aren't like regular cricket legs.
A. cannot B. is not
C. are not D. do not

Determine if the sentence is a declarative(d), exclamatory(e), interrogative(i) or imperative(m).

- 57) It's amazing how mole crickets shed their skin several times!
58) Educate others about mole crickets and their importance in the ecosystem.
59) Do mole crickets harm humans?
60) Wow, mole crickets can grow up to 1.5 inches long!
61) Mole crickets are known for damaging lawns and gardens.
62) What color are mole crickets?
63) Mole crickets use their powerful front legs to dig.
64) Where do mole crickets lay their eggs?
65) Mole crickets live underground.
66) Protect their habitat by not using harmful pesticides.
67) I can't believe mole crickets eat other mole crickets!
68) Please be gentle and let the mole crickets go if you find them.



Mole Crickets

Name: _____

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| 1. _____ | 26. _____ | 51. _____ |
| 2. _____ | 27. _____ | 52. _____ |
| 3. _____ | 28. _____ | 53. _____ |
| 4. _____ | 29. _____ | 54. _____ |
| 5. _____ | 30. _____ | 55. _____ |
| 6. _____ | 31. _____ | 56. _____ |
| 7. _____ | 32. _____ | 57. _____ |
| 8. _____ | 33. _____ | 58. _____ |
| 9. _____ | 34. _____ | 59. _____ |
| 10. _____ | 35. _____ | 60. _____ |
| 11. _____ | 36. _____ | 61. _____ |
| 12. _____ | 37. _____ | 62. _____ |
| 13. _____ | 38. _____ | 63. _____ |
| 14. _____ | 39. _____ | 64. _____ |
| 15. _____ | 40. _____ | 65. _____ |
| 16. _____ | 41. _____ | 66. _____ |
| 17. _____ | 42. _____ | 67. _____ |
| 18. _____ | 43. _____ | 68. _____ |
| 19. _____ | 44. _____ | |
| 20. _____ | 45. _____ | |
| 21. _____ | 46. _____ | |
| 22. _____ | 47. _____ | |
| 23. _____ | 48. _____ | |
| 24. _____ | 49. _____ | |
| 25. _____ | 50. _____ | |



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Mole Crickets

Name: _____

1.	C	26.	Would	51.	D
2.	C	27.	Would	52.	D
3.	B	28.	Not	53.	D
4.	D	29.	Would	54.	D
5.	A	30.	Would	55.	C
6.	A	31.	fact	56.	C
7.	D	32.	opinion	57.	exclamatory
8.	B	33.	fact	58.	imperative
9.	B	34.	opinion	59.	interrogative
10.	B	35.	fact	60.	exclamatory
11.	Not	36.	opinion	61.	declarative
12.	Not	37.	fact	62.	interrogative
13.	Would	38.	fact	63.	declarative
14.	Not	39.	opinion	64.	interrogative
15.	Not	40.	opinion	65.	declarative
16.	Not	41.	true	66.	imperative
17.	Would	42.	false	67.	exclamatory
18.	Would	43.	true	68.	imperative
19.	Would	44.	false		
20.	Not	45.	true		
21.	Not	46.	false		
22.	Not	47.	false		
23.	Would	48.	false		
24.	Not	49.	true		
25.	Would	50.	true		